

FREE TEMPLATE

The Global-Standard CV Template

A clean, ATS-friendly CV structure built specifically for remote and international applications — plus the exact wording patterns that get African applicants taken seriously by global employers.

Prepared by Shine To Freedom Enterprises | CAC: BN 8331508

Why Most CVs Get Rejected Before a Human Reads Them

A strong candidate with a poorly structured CV loses to a weaker candidate with a clean one — every time. Here is what is actually happening behind the scenes:

- Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) scan CVs for structure and keywords before any human sees them. Fancy designs with tables, columns, and graphics often get scrambled or rejected outright by these systems.
- Vague job titles and duties ("Worked in customer service") give a recruiter nothing to evaluate. Global employers want outcomes, not duties.
- Missing or unclear contact information (no professional email, no clear country/timezone) creates doubt before the recruiter even reads your experience.
- Long, unfocused CVs (3+ pages for early-career applicants) signal a candidate who can't prioritize — a red flag for remote roles requiring self-direction.

The current market trend: recruiters at remote-first companies spend an average of under 10 seconds on first-pass CV review. Clarity beats creativity. A simple, well-structured one-page CV consistently outperforms a "designed" one for early applications.

The Template Structure

Use this exact section order. It mirrors what ATS systems and international recruiters expect to see, in the order they expect to see it.

1. Header

Full name, professional email, phone (with country code), location (city, country), and one link (LinkedIn or portfolio). No photo — most international employers do not expect or want one.

2. Professional Summary (2-3 lines)

Not an objective. A summary of what you do and the outcomes you create. Example: "Customer support specialist with 2 years' experience resolving 50+ tickets daily across email and chat, maintaining a 95% satisfaction rating."

3. Core Skills

A short list (6-10 items) of concrete, scannable skills — tools, platforms, and methods, not soft-skill adjectives.

4. Experience

Reverse chronological. Each role: title, company, dates, location/remote status, then 3-4 bullet points starting with action verbs and ending with a measurable outcome where possible.

5. Education

Degree, institution, year. Keep brief unless you are very early-career, in which case this can move higher.

6. Optional: Certifications / Projects

Relevant certifications or independent projects that prove capability, especially valuable if formal experience is limited.

Wording That Gets You Taken Seriously

Replace duty-based language with outcome-based language:

Weak: "Responsible for managing social media accounts."

Strong: "Grew Instagram engagement by 40% over 3 months through a structured weekly content calendar."

Weak: "Handled customer inquiries."

Strong: "Resolved an average of 60 customer inquiries daily via live chat, maintaining a 4.8/5 satisfaction score."

Even without dramatic numbers, specificity wins. "Completed 200+ data entry tasks with 99% accuracy" beats "good with data entry" even at small scale — it shows you think in outcomes.

Before You Submit — Final Checklist

- ☐ One page (two only if you have 7+ years of relevant experience)
 - ☐ No tables, columns, text boxes, or graphics that could confuse an ATS
 - ☐ Standard fonts only (Arial, Calibri, Helvetica)
 - ☐ File saved and submitted as PDF unless the application specifically requests .docx
 - ☐ File named clearly: FirstName-LastName-CV.pdf
 - ☐ Every bullet point starts with an action verb
 - ☐ Spelling and grammar checked — read it backwards, sentence by sentence, to catch errors
-

Want Us to Build It For You?

Shine To Freedom offers professional CV Revamp and Fresh CV Creation services — we apply everything in this guide and tailor it specifically to your background and target roles. Message us on Telegram to get started.